

Gentlemen of the Rittenhouse Club,

It is with great enthusiasm that I recommend Captain Luke McCaleb for membership in The Rittenhouse Club. Having known Luke for over a decade, I can confidently say that he is one of the most genuine, respected, and selfless people I know. His character, leadership, and commitment to those around him make him an ideal candidate for our organization.

Luke and I first met at Gonzaga College High School in Washington, D.C., where we became friends through freshman football and lacrosse. Even at a young age, Luke distinguished himself as a natural leader, eventually serving as captain of both the varsity football and lacrosse teams. He was also one of the most universally well-liked members of our class, a reputation he has maintained long after graduation. Nearly a decade later, Luke has taken it upon himself to keep our high school class connected, organizing reunions and maintaining a communication channel that continues to bring our classmates together.

After Gonzaga, Luke attended Brown University, where he played on the men's lacrosse team and served as a three-time captain. Growing up with a father who served in the Army, Luke developed a deep respect for the military and knew from an early age that he wanted to become a Marine. Following graduation, he fulfilled that lifelong ambition and was commissioned as an officer in the United States Marine Corps, eventually earning the rank of Captain. During his service, he was stationed in Okinawa, Japan, where he served as a Platoon Commander and later as a Company Executive Officer.

Since arriving at Wharton, Luke has quickly established himself as a leader among his classmates. He is an active member of the Veterans Club and a player on the Wharton Rugby Team, where he has built strong relationships and become a respected member of both communities. Despite recently getting married and balancing the demands of business school, Luke has made it a priority to remain involved in the broader Wharton community. He is a regular at Dive Bar Wednesdays and someone who consistently makes the effort to attend social events and build relationships outside his immediate circle. It is no surprise that he is quickly becoming one of the most well-liked and respected members of his class.

What I respect most about Luke is that, despite everything he has accomplished, he remains the same humble and approachable person I met over ten years ago. He is the type of friend who will go out of his way for the people around him, and his commitment to maintaining friendships and bringing people together is something I have witnessed firsthand throughout our lives. I cannot think of many people better suited for the brotherhood and traditions of The Rittenhouse Club.

Capt. McCaleb's candidacy is seconded by Staff Sergeant Rothe, Mr. Atwood, and Mr. Matt Friday (TRC ’25).

In the Bonds,
JD Smeallie